

Taylor Heffington

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Education

Illinois Institute of Technology

Chicago, IL

Master of Data Science, GPA 3.68

August 2025 - December 2026

University of California, Santa Cruz

Santa Cruz, CA

Bachelor of Computer Science

September 2021 - June 2025

- Relevant Coursework: Data Structures and Algorithms, Machine Learning, Relational Database Design, Data Preparation and Analysis, Statistical Learning, Big Data Technologies, Computer Architecture

Experience

Data Engineering Intern

December 2025 – Present

UmiUni

Los Angeles, CA

- Architected UmiUni's core market data infrastructure using Redis/RQ and FastAPI, enabling real-time equity ingestion and Metabase-powered trading research dashboards
- Engineered a high-throughput ingestion pipeline processing 38M rows of historical equity data into a year-partitioned MySQL database, optimizing performance via parallel workers and 10,000-row batch inserts.

Data Engineering Intern

September 2025 – December 2025

Deepiri

Los Angeles, CA

- Built an automated dataset QA tool for Diri Cyrex, reducing manual data review time by ~30%.
- Engineered a Python training pipeline for Cyrex's intent classifier, scaling the dataset from 5,000 to 7,000 examples with Llama 3-powered data augmentation via Ollama.
- Implemented CI/CD pipelines using Airflow to orchestrate dbt data transformation workflows, enabling automated and reliable data processing.

Data Intern

April 2025 – June 2025

Casa Blue

Santa Cruz, CA

- Automated Python workflows to validate, normalize, and clean ~5 GB datasets integrating with Webflow's CMS collections for 10+ clients.
- Partnered with the founder and cross-functional teams to drive UX/UI decisions via validated data, shaping client's deliverables.

Projects

Real-Time Stock Sentiment Pipeline | Python, Redis, MySQL, FastAPI, Metabase, Airflow, HuggingFace

- Engineered an end-to-end equity sentiment pipeline ingesting Reddit and SEC filings across 1,000+ tickers, orchestrating FinBERT scoring via Airflow DAGs and surfacing sentiment-price correlations with Metabase.
- Exposed sentiment signals via a FastAPI query layer backed by a partitioned MySQL database, enabling downstream consumption for ML-driven trading algorithms.

Change-Data-Capture | Python, PostgreSQL, Debezium, Kafka, BigQuery, dbt, Github Actions, Docker

- Built a CDC pipeline using Debezium + Kafka replicating 500K+ daily events from Postgres to BigQuery with dbt transformations, automated schema drift handling, and CI/CD via GitHub Actions.
- Automated schema evolution handling for source column changes; fully containerized via Docker Compose

Skills

Languages: Python, SQL, C/C++, R, JavaScript, HTML/CSS

Technologies: Docker, Airflow, Kafka, PostgreSQL, MySQL, FastAPI, Redis, dbt, Metabase, Git

Libraries: PyTorch, TensorFlow, LangChain, LangSmith, scikit-learn, Pandas, NumPy, OpenCV, Redis